

Logos 聚会

2026-07-11

使徒行传 8:18 - 35

关键成果

本次学习继续研读使徒行传第 8 章 18-35

节, 涵盖两个主要叙事: 行邪术的西门错误地试图购买属灵能力, 以及腓利顺服地向埃塞俄比亚太监传福音。小组探讨了真正的信心与被权力欲望或外在神迹驱动的信心之间的区别。关键神学主题包括: 圣灵作为敬拜对象而非可控制力量的本质、洗礼作为救恩保证的局限性, 以及以赛亚书 53 章关于弥赛亚的预言在耶稣基督身上的应验。

做出的决定

- 西门的得救状态被使徒行传作者路加刻意留下模糊; 小组认为这种模糊性是有意为之, 作为对所有信徒的警告, 而非仅针对西门个人的判决。
- 婴儿洗礼不能保证救恩; 西门受洗却没有明显的真正转变被引用为主要的圣经例证。
- 洗礼是信心的外在公开宣告, 而非内在转变的保证—两者并不总是一致。
- 以赛亚书 53 章被理解为关于耶稣的详细弥赛亚预言, 写于耶稣降生前约 700 年, 早于罗马人发明钉十字架的刑罚。

核心教导: 行邪术的西门 (使徒行传 8:18-25)

西门的两个神学错误

- 错误 1—
误解属灵恩赐: 西门认为属灵能力是可以拥有、获取或购买的东西。正确的理解是: 属灵恩赐是神凭恩典白白赐予的, 神是主权的施予者。
- 错误 2—误解圣灵: 西门将圣灵视为可以控制并用来辖制他人的能力, 而非作为神圣位格—三位一体的第三位—来敬拜、尊崇和建立关系。
- 一个真正悔改的信徒会询问如何在信心中成长、如何服事教会, 或如何更深地认识耶稣。西门渴望的是能力本身, 这揭示了他内心的取向。

“西门买卖圣职”作为历史现象

- 西门的名字成为术语“西门买卖圣职”(simony)的词根—买卖属灵职位、祝福或教会职务。

- 这种错误不仅限于新信徒或不成熟的信徒;纵观教会历史,即使是成熟的领袖也曾陷入将圣灵视为权力和繁荣来源而非敬拜对象的错误。
- 成功神学被引用为当代的相似例子—将属灵能力视为可以为个人利益而获取的东西。

彼得的回应:通过悔改带来盼望

- 彼得严厉责备西门,但也为他提供了前进的道路:悔改并寻求神的赦免。
- 彼得的诊断—西门“正在苦胆之中,被罪恶捆绑”—具有广泛适用性;所有信徒都在与罪性和肉体争战。
- 小组注意到西门请使徒们为他祷告,而非亲自在神面前悔改—这是一个微妙但重要的区别。

关于代祷与个人悔改

- 虽然牧师和领袖可以也应该为他人祷告,但没有人能代替他人获得赦免;只有神赐予赦免。
- 当个人亲自来到神面前时,神更加喜悦—即使是最软弱的信徒在神面前的个人祷告,在个人转变方面也比让别人为他祷告更有力量。
- 个人的谦卑和在神面前的直接认罪是领受赦免和更新的必要条件。

核心教导:腓利与埃塞俄比亚太监(使徒行传 8:26-35)

腓利的顺服

- 在撒玛利亚经历了重大复兴—医治、悔改归主、大喜乐—之后,一位天使指示腓利离开,前往通往加沙的旷野路上,没有给出任何解释。
- 从人的角度看,放弃蓬勃发展的城市复兴去往空旷的旷野路上毫无逻辑可言。
- 腓利立即顺服,没有犹豫、争辩或讨价还价—经文在这一点上的简洁突显了他的谦卑和信靠。
- 教训:神对成功的定义不是用人群规模或事工规模来衡量的;在神眼中,一个人的得救同样重要。

埃塞俄比亚太监:人物简介

- 高级官员—相当于财政部长—在埃塞俄比亚女王干大基手下,掌管王室财库。
- 受过高等教育;在从耶路撒冷敬拜归来的路上正在阅读以赛亚书卷轴(用希伯来文写成)。
- 他愿意在艰苦条件下(炎热、乘坐马车长途跋涉)走如此远的路程,显示了真诚的属灵渴慕。
- 尽管他受过教育且地位显赫,他谦卑地承认没有指导就无法理解所读的内容—展现了可教导性的基本姿态。

埃塞俄比亚的圣经背景

- 埃塞俄比亚(古代的古实)在旧约历史中占有重要地位:示巴女王拜访所罗门,被他的智慧和圣殿的荣耀所折服,认识了神,并返回家乡—在埃塞俄比亚建立了对神的信仰传统。
- 这一传承解释了为什么埃塞俄比亚官员会阅读希伯来经文并在耶路撒冷敬拜。
- 埃塞俄比亚保持了超过一千年的基督教社群,可追溯到这一早期联系。

以赛亚书 53 章:被禁止的章节

- 太监正在阅读以赛亚书 53 章,该章描述了一位受苦的仆人—关于耶稣的降生、事工、受难、钉十字架和救赎之死的详细预言。
- 写于公元前约 700 年,以赛亚书 53 章早于罗马人发明钉十字架的刑罚,却精确地描述了它—被引用为神圣默示的证据。
- 在今天的犹太教中,以赛亚书 53 章是“被禁止的章节”—在会堂读经中被跳过,因为它太直接地适用于耶稣作为弥赛亚。
- 犹太人对该段落的常见解释:(1)以赛亚在写他自己;(2)该段落描述以色列民族的集体受难。
- 许多犹太人无法接受受苦的弥赛亚—他们期待的是一位强大的、征服的君王,恢复以色列的国家荣耀。
- 伊斯兰教同样尊崇耶稣为先知,但否认他作为弥赛亚或神子的身份,原因相同:受苦的、被钉十字架的弥赛亚与他们的荣耀神学不相容。
- 太监开放的问题—“先知说的是谁,是他自己还是别人?”—给了腓利机会来解释耶稣基督的完整福音。

耶稣在审判中的沉默:预言的应验

- 以赛亚书 53 章描述仆人在控告者面前沉默,“像羊被牵到宰杀之地”。
- 耶稣在彼拉多和犹太领袖面前受审时的沉默不是软弱,而是甘心顺服神的计划,刻意应验以赛亚的预言。
- 彼拉多本人找不到控告耶稣的理由,但耶稣接受了不公正的判决—承担羞辱,使罪人能够得到义。
- 即使是见证过变像的耶稣自己的门徒,在钉十字架时也逃跑了一—表明在耶稣的时代没有人完全理解正在发生的事。

为以色列和穆斯林社群祷告

- 越来越多的犹太人归信耶稣,接受以赛亚书 53 章为弥赛亚预言,但他们仍是少数。

- 小组被鼓励为犹太人和穆斯林祷告, 使他们从对弥赛亚的先入之见中得释放, 遇见真正的耶稣—谦卑的、生在马槽里的、作为罪犯被钉十字架的, 却是所有预言的应验。
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Logos Meeting

2026-07-11

Acts 8:18 - 35

Key Outcomes

This session continued the study of Acts chapter 8, verses 18–35, covering two major narratives: Simon the Sorcerer's misguided attempt to purchase spiritual power, and Philip's obedient mission to evangelize the Ethiopian eunuch. The group examined what genuine faith looks like versus a faith driven by desire for power or external signs. Key theological themes included the nature of the Holy Spirit as a person to worship rather than a force to control, the limits of baptism as a guarantee of salvation, and the messianic prophecy of Isaiah 53 as fulfilled in Jesus Christ.

Decisions Made

- **Simon's salvation status is deliberately left ambiguous** by Luke, the author of Acts; the group concluded this ambiguity is intentional and serves as a warning to all believers, not a verdict on Simon alone.
 - **Infant baptism does not guarantee salvation**; Simon's baptism without apparent genuine transformation was cited as the primary biblical example.
 - **Baptism is an external, public declaration of faith**, not a guarantee of inner transformation — the two do not always coincide.
 - **Isaiah 53 is understood as a detailed messianic prophecy** about Jesus, written approximately 700 years before his birth, predating the Roman invention of crucifixion.
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Core Teaching: Simon the Sorcerer (Acts 8:18–25)

Simon's Two Theological Errors

- **Error 1 — Misunderstanding spiritual gifts:** Simon believed spiritual power was something that could be possessed, acquired, or purchased. The correct understanding is that spiritual gifts are freely given by God's grace, with God as the sovereign initiator.

- **Error 2 — Misunderstanding the Holy Spirit:** Simon viewed the Holy Spirit as a power to control and wield over others, rather than as a divine person — the third member of the Trinity — to be worshipped, revered, and related to.
- A genuinely converted believer would ask how to grow in faith, how to serve the church, or how to know Jesus more deeply. Simon's desire was for the ability itself, revealing the orientation of his heart.

"Simony" as a Historical Phenomenon

- Simon's name became the root of the term "**simony**" — the buying or selling of spiritual positions, blessings, or church offices.
- This error is not limited to new or immature believers; throughout church history, even mature leaders have fallen into treating the Holy Spirit as a source of power and prosperity rather than as God to be worshipped.
- The **prosperity gospel** was cited as a contemporary parallel — treating spiritual power as something to be obtained for personal benefit.

Peter's Response: Hope Through Repentance

- Peter rebuked Simon sharply but also offered him a path forward: **repent and seek God's forgiveness**.
- Peter's diagnosis — that Simon was "full of bitterness and captive to sin" — applies broadly; all believers struggle with sinful nature and the flesh.
- The group noted that Simon asked the apostles to pray *for* him rather than personally repenting before God — a subtle but significant distinction.

On Intercessory Prayer vs. Personal Repentance

- While pastors and leaders can and should pray for others, **no one can obtain forgiveness on another's behalf**; only God grants forgiveness.
- God is more pleased when individuals come before Him personally — even the weakest believer's own prayer before God is more powerful in terms of personal transformation than having someone else pray for them.
- Personal humility and direct confession before God are the essential conditions for receiving forgiveness and renewal.

Core Teaching: Philip and the Ethiopian Eunuch (Acts 8:26–35)

Philip's Obedience

- After a significant revival in Samaria — healings, conversions, great joy — an angel directed Philip to leave and travel to a desert road toward Gaza, with no explanation given.
- From a human perspective, abandoning a thriving urban revival for an empty desert road made no logical sense.
- Philip **obeyed immediately without hesitation, argument, or negotiation** — the text's brevity on this point underscores his humility and trust.
- Lesson: **God's definition of success is not measured by crowd size or ministry scale**; a single person's salvation is equally significant in God's eyes.

The Ethiopian Eunuch: Profile

- A high-ranking official — equivalent to a **Finance Minister** — under the Ethiopian queen Candace, overseeing the royal treasury.
- Highly educated; was reading the scroll of Isaiah (written in Hebrew) on his return from Jerusalem, where he had gone to worship.
- His willingness to travel such a great distance under harsh conditions (heat, long journey by chariot) demonstrated **genuine spiritual hunger**.
- Despite his education and status, he **humbly admitted he could not understand what he was reading** without guidance — modeling the essential posture of teachability.

Ethiopia's Biblical Background

- Ethiopia (ancient Cush) has a significant place in Old Testament history: the **Queen of Sheba** visited Solomon, was impressed by his wisdom and the glory of the temple, came to know God, and returned home — establishing a tradition of faith in God in Ethiopia.
- This heritage explains why an Ethiopian official would be reading Hebrew scriptures and worshipping in Jerusalem.
- Ethiopia has maintained a **Christian community for over a thousand years**, traceable to this early connection.

Isaiah 53: The Forbidden Chapter

- The eunuch was reading **Isaiah 53**, which describes a suffering servant — a detailed prophecy of Jesus' birth, ministry, suffering, crucifixion, and redemptive death.

- Written ~700 BC, Isaiah 53 predates the Roman invention of crucifixion, yet describes it with precision — cited as evidence of divine inspiration.
- **In Judaism today, Isaiah 53 is a "forbidden chapter"** — skipped in synagogue readings because it is too directly applicable to Jesus as Messiah.
- Common Jewish interpretations of the passage: (1) Isaiah writing about himself; (2) the passage describing the collective suffering of the nation of Israel.
- Many Jews cannot accept a **suffering Messiah** — their expectation is of a powerful, conquering king who restores Israel's national glory.
- **Islam similarly honors Jesus as a prophet** but denies his identity as Messiah or Son of God, for the same reason: a suffering, crucified Messiah is incompatible with their theology of honor.
- The eunuch's open question — "Who is the prophet talking about, himself or someone else?" — gave Philip the opening to explain the full gospel of Jesus Christ.

Jesus' Silence at Trial: Fulfillment of Prophecy

- Isaiah 53 describes the servant as silent before his accusers, "like a sheep to the slaughter."
- Jesus' silence during his trial before Pilate and the Jewish leaders was **not weakness** but willing submission to God's plan and deliberate fulfillment of Isaiah's prophecy.
- Pilate himself found no basis for charges against Jesus, yet Jesus accepted the unjust verdict — bearing the shame so that sinners could receive righteousness.
- Even Jesus' own disciples, who had witnessed the Transfiguration, fled at the crucifixion — demonstrating that no one in Jesus' time fully understood what was happening.

Prayer for Israel and Muslim Communities

- Growing numbers of Jewish people are coming to faith in Jesus and accepting Isaiah 53 as messianic prophecy, but they remain a minority.
- The group was encouraged to **pray for Jewish people and Muslims** to be freed from their preconceptions about the Messiah and to encounter the true Jesus — humble, born in a manger, crucified as a criminal, yet the fulfillment of all prophecy.